INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS SESSION 12

GIVE & FAST

Intensity "Asking For" & "Saying No"

Guidelines for Relationship Effectiveness: Keeping the Relationship (GIVE)

A way to remember these skills is to remember the word **GIVE (DEAR MAN, GIVE):**

(Be) **G**entle
(Act) **I**nterested
Validate
(Use an) **E**asy manner

(Be)
Gentle BE NICE and respectful.

No attacks: No verbal or physical attacks. No hitting, clenching fists. No harassment of any kind. Express anger directly with words.

No threats: If you have to describe painful consequences for not getting what you want, describe them calmly and without exaggerating.
No "manipulative" statements, no hidden threats. No "I'll kill myself if you . . . "
Tolerate a "no." Stay in the discussion even if it gets painful. Exit gracefully.

No judging: No moralizing. No "If you were a good person, you would . . . "
No "You should . . . " or "You shouldn't . . . " Abandon blame.

No sneering: No smirking, eye rolling, sucking teeth. No cutting off or walking away.
No saying, "That's stupid, don't be sad," "I don't care what you say."

(Act)
Interested LISTEN and APPEAR INTERESTED in the other person.
Listen to the other person's point of view.
Face the person; maintain eye contact; lean toward the person rather than away. Don't interrupt or talk over the person.
Be sensitive to the person's wish to have the discussion at a later time. Be patient.

Validate With WORDS AND ACTIONS, show that you understand the other person's feelings and thoughts about the situation. See the world from the other person's point of view, and then say or act on what you see.

"I realize this is hard for you, and . . . ", "I see that you are busy, and . . . "

Go to a private place when the person is uncomfortable talking in a public place.

(Use an)
Easy manner Use a little humor.
SMILE. Ease the person along. Be light-hearted. Sweet-talk.
Use a "soft sell" over a "hard sell." Be "political."
Leave your attitude at the door.

Other ideas: _____

_____

_____

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Guidelines for Self-Respect Effectiveness: Keeping Respect for Yourself (FAST)

A way to remember these skills is to remember the word **FAST (DEAR MAN, GIVE FAST).**

(Be) **F**air
(No) **A**pologies
Stick to Values
(Be) **T**ruthful

(Be) **Fair**

Be fair to YOURSELF and to the OTHER person.
Remember to VALIDATE YOUR OWN feelings and wishes, as well as the other person's.

(No) **Apologies**

Don't overapologize.
No apologizing for being alive or for making a request at all.
No apologies for having an opinion, for disagreeing.
No LOOKING ASHAMED, with eyes and head down or body slumped.
No invalidating the valid.

Stick to values

Stick to YOUR OWN values.
Don't sell out your values or integrity for reasons that aren't VERY important.
Be clear on what you believe is the moral or valued way of thinking and acting, and "stick to your guns."

(Be) **Truthful**

Don't lie. Don't act helpless when you are not.
Don't exaggerate or make up excuses.

Other ideas: _____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

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(Interpersonal Effectiveness Worksheet 6)

Evaluating Options for Whether or How Intensely to Ask for Something or Say No

Before asking for something or saying no to a request, you have to decide how intensely you want to hold your ground.

Options range from **very low** intensity, where you are very flexible and accept the situation as it is, to **very high** intensity, where you try every skill you know to change the situation and get what you want.

OPTIONS

Low intensity (let go, give in)

Asking		***Saying No***
Don't ask; don't hint.	1	Do what the other person wants without being asked.
Hint indirectly; take no.	2	Don't complain; do it cheerfully.
Hint openly; take no.	3	Do it, even if you're not cheerful about it.
Ask tentatively; take no.	4	Do it, but show that you'd rather not.
Ask gracefully, but take no.	5	Say you'd rather not, but do it gracefully.
Ask confidently; take no.	6	Say no confidently, but reconsider.
Ask confidently; resist no.	7	Say no confidently; resist saying yes.
Ask firmly; resist no.	8	Say no firmly; resist saying yes.
Ask firmly; insist; negotiate; keep trying.	9	Say no firmly; resist; negotiate; keep trying.
Ask and don't take no for an answer.	**10**	**Don't do it.**

High intensity (stay firm)

FACTORS TO CONSIDER

When deciding how firm or intense you want to be in asking or saying no, think about:

1. The other person's or your own **capability.**
2. Your **priorities.**
3. The effect of your actions on your **self-respect.**
4. Your or the other's moral and legal **rights** in the situation.
5. Your **authority** over the person (or his or hers over you).
6. The type of **relationship** you have with the person.
7. The effect of your action on **long- versus short-term goals.**
8. The degree of **give and take** in your relationship.
9. Whether you have done your **homework** to prepare.
10. The **timing** of your request or refusal.

1. CAPABILITY:

- Is the person able to give you what you want? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Do you have what the person wants? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

2. PRIORITIES:

- Are your GOALS very important? Increase intensity.
- Is your RELATIONSHIP shaky? Consider reducing intensity.
- Is your SELF-RESPECT on the line? Intensity should fit your values.

3. SELF-RESPECT:

- Do you usually do things for yourself? Are you careful to avoid acting helpless when you are not? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Will saying no make you feel bad about yourself, even when you are thinking about it wisely? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

4. RIGHTS:

- Is the person required by law or moral code to give you what you want? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Are you required to give the person what he or she is asking for? Would saying no violate the other person's rights? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

5. AUTHORITY:

- Are you responsible for directing the person or telling the person what to do? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Does the person have authority over you (e.g., your boss, your teacher)? And is what the person is asking within his or her authority? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

(***continued on next page***)

6. RELATIONSHIP:

- Is what you want appropriate to the current relationship? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Is what the person is asking for appropriate to your current relationship? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

7. LONG-TERM VERSUS SHORT-TERM GOALS:

- Will not asking for what you want keep the peace now but create problems in the long run? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Is giving in to keep the peace right now more important than the long-term welfare of the relationship? Will you eventually regret or resent saying no? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

8. GIVE AND TAKE:

- What have you done for the person? Are you giving at least as much as you ask for? Are you willing to give if the person says yes? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Do you owe this person a favor? Does he or she do a lot for you? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

9. HOMEWORK:

- Have you done your homework? Do you know all the facts you need to know to support your request? Are you clear about what you want? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Is the other person's request clear? Do you know what you are agreeing to? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

10. TIMING:

- Is this a good time to ask? Is the person "in the mood" for listening and paying attention to you? Are you catching the person when he or she is likely to say yes to your request? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
- Is this a bad time to say no? Should you hold off answering for a while? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

(Interpersonal Effectiveness Worksheet 7)

Troubleshooting: When What You Are Doing Isn't Working

1

Do I have the skills I need? Check out the instructions.

Review what has already been tried.

- Do I know how to be skillful in getting what I want?
- Do I know how to say what I want to say?
- Do I follow the skill instructions to the letter?

2

Do I know what I really want in this interaction?

Ask:

- Am I undecided about what I really want in this interaction?
- Am I unsure of my priorities?
- Am I having trouble balancing:
  - Asking for too much versus too little?
  - Saying no to everything versus saying yes to everything?
- Is fear or shame getting in the way of knowing what I really want?

3

Are short-term goals getting in the way of long-term goals?

Ask:

- Is "NOW, NOW, NOW" winning out over getting what I really want in the future?
- Is emotion mind controlling what I say and do instead of WISE MIND?

(***continued on next page***)

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4

Are my emotions getting in the way of using my skills?

Ask:

- Do I get too upset to use my skills?
- Are my emotions so HIGH that I am over my skills breakdown point?

5

Are worries, assumptions, and myths getting in my way?

Ask:

- Are THOUGHTS about bad consequences blocking my action?
  "They won't like me," "She will think I am stupid."
- Are THOUGHTS about not deserving things getting in my way?
  "I am such a bad person I don't deserve this."
- Am I calling myself NAMES that stop me from doing anything?
  "I won't do it right," "I'll probably fall apart," "I'm so stupid."
- Do I believe MYTHS about interpersonal effectiveness?
  "If I make a request, this will show that I am a weak person,"
  "Only wimps have values."

6

Is the environment more powerful than my skills?

Ask:

- Are the people who have what I want or need more powerful than I am?
- Are other people more in control of the situation than I am?
- Will others be threatened if I get what I want?
- Do others have reasons for not liking me if I get what I want?

7

Other ideas:

(Interpersonal Effectiveness Handout 8)

The Dime Game: Figuring Out How Strongly to Ask or Say No

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

To figure out how strongly to ask for something or how strongly to say no, read the instructions below. Circle the dimes you put in the bank, and then add them up. Then go back over the list and see if some items are much more important than others. Check Wise Mind before acting, if some items are much more important than others.

Decide how strongly to ask for something. Put a dime in the bank for each of the questions that get a yes answer. The more money you have, the stronger you ask. If you have a dollar, then ask very strongly. If you don't have any money in the bank, then don't ask; don't even hint.			**Decide how strongly to say no.** Put a dime in the bank for each of the questions that get a no answer. The more money you have, the stronger you say no. If you have a dollar, then say no very strongly. If you don't have any money in the bank, then do it without even being asked.	
10¢	Is this person able to give or do what I want?	**Capability**	Can I give the person what is wanted?	10¢
10¢	Is getting my objective more important than my relationship with this person?	**Priorities**	Is my relationship more important than saying no?	10¢
10¢	Will asking help me feel competent and self-respecting?	**Self-respect**	Will saying no make me feel bad about myself?	10¢
10¢	Is the person required by law or moral code to do or give me what I want?	**Rights**	Am I required by law or moral code to give or do what is wanted, or does saying no violate this person's rights?	10¢
10¢	Am I responsible for telling the person what to do?	**Authority**	Is the other person responsible for telling me what to do?	10¢
10¢	Is what I want appropriate for this relationship? (Is it right to ask for what I want?)	**Relationship**	Is what the person is requesting of me appropriate to my relationship with this person?	10¢
10¢	Is asking important to a long-term goal?	**Goals**	In the long term, will I regret saying no?	10¢
10¢	Do I give as much as I get with this person?	**Give and take**	Do I owe this person a favor? (Does the person do a lot for me?)	10¢
10¢	Do I know what I want and have the facts I need to support my request?	**Homework**	Do I know what I am saying no to? (Is the other person clear about what is being asked for?)	10¢
10¢	Is this a good time to ask? (Is the person in the right mood?)	**Timing**	Should I wait a while before saying no?	10¢
$	**Total value of asking** (Adjusted ± ____ for Wise Mind)		**Total value of saying no** (Adjusted ± ____for Wise Mind)	$

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ASKING		SAYING NO
Don't ask; don't hint.	0–10¢	Do it without being asked.
Hint indirectly; take no.	20¢	Don't complain; do it cheerfully.
Hint openly; take no.	30¢	Do it, even if you're not cheerful about it.
Ask tentatively; take no.	40¢	Do it, but show that you'd rather not.
Ask gracefully, but take no.	50¢	Say you'd rather not, but do it gracefully.
Ask confidently; take no.	60¢	Say no firmly, but reconsider.
Ask confidently; resist no.	70¢	Say no confidently; resist saying yes.
Ask firmly; resist no.	80¢	Say no firmly; resist saying yes.
Ask firmly; insist; negotiate; keep trying.	90¢	Say no firmly; resist; negotiate.
Don't take no for an answer.	$1.00	Don't do it.

INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS WORKSHEET 4

(Interpersonal Effectiveness Handouts 5, 6, 7)

Writing Out Interpersonal Effectiveness Scripts

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Fill out this sheet before you practice your DEAR MAN, GIVE FAST interpersonal skills. Practice saying your "lines" out loud, and also in your mind. Use the "cope ahead" skills (Emotion Regulation Handout 19).

PROMPTING EVENT for my problem: Who did what to whom? What led up to what?

OBJECTIVES IN SITUATION (What results I want):

RELATIONSHIP ISSUE (How I want the other person to feel about me):

SELF-RESPECT ISSUE (How I want to feel about myself):

SCRIPT IDEAS for DEAR MAN, GIVE FAST

1. **Describe** situation.
2. **Express** feelings/opinions.
3. **Assert** request (or say no) directly (circle the part you will use later in "broken record" to stay **Mindful** if you need it).
4. **Reinforcing** comments to make.
5. **Mindful and Appearing** confident comments to make (if needed).

6 **Negotiating** comments to make, plus turn-the-table comments (if needed).

7. **Validating** comments.
8. **Easy manner** comments.

Write on another page, all the things you want to *avoid* doing or saying.

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INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS WORKSHEET 5

(Interpersonal Effectiveness Handouts 5, 6, 7)

Tracking Interpersonal Effectiveness Skills Use

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Fill out this sheet whenever you practice your interpersonal skills and whenever you have an oppor-tunity to practice, even if you don't (or almost don't) do anything to practice.

PROMPTING EVENT for my problem: Who did what to whom? What led up to what?

OBJECTIVES IN SITUATION (What results I want):

RELATIONSHIP ISSUE (How I want the other person to feel about me):

SELF-RESPECT ISSUE (How I want to feel about myself):

My PRIORITIES in this situation: Rate priorities 1 (most important), 2 (second most important), or 3 (least important).

____OBJECTIVES ____RELATIONSHIP ____SELF-RESPECT

Imbalances and CONFLICTS IN PRIORITIES that made it hard to be effective in this situation:

What I SAID OR DID in the situation: (Describe and check below.)

DEAR MAN (Getting what I want):

____ Described situation?_____
____ Expressed feelings/opinions?_____
____ Asserted?_____
____ Reinforced?_____
____ Mindful?_____
____ Broken record?_____
____ Ignored attacks?_____
____ Appeared confident?_____
____ Negotiated?_____

GIVE (Keeping the relationship):

____ Gentle?_____
____ No threats?_____
____ No attacks?_____
____ No judgments?_____
____ Interested?_____
____ Validated?_____
____ Easy manner?_____

FAST (Keeping my respect for myself):

____ Fair?_____
____ (No) Apologies?_____
____ Stuck to values?_____
____ Truthful?_____

How effective was the interaction? _____

_____

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